

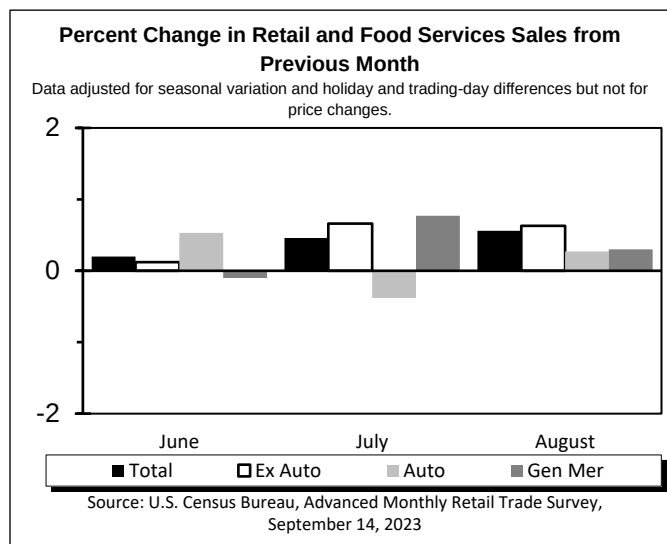
FOR RELEASE AT 8:30 AM EDT, THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2023

ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES FOR RETAIL AND FOOD SERVICES, AUGUST 2023

Release Number: CB23-148

September 14, 2023 — The U.S. Census Bureau announced the following advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for August 2023:

ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES		
August 2023	\$697.6 billion	0.6%
July 2023 (revised)	\$693.7 billion	0.5%
Next release: October 17, 2023		
* The 90 percent confidence interval includes zero. There is insufficient statistical evidence to conclude that the actual change is different from zero. Data adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences but not for price changes. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advanced Monthly Retail Trade Survey, September 14, 2023		



Advance Estimates of U.S. Retail and Food Services

Advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for August 2023, adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences, but not for price changes, were \$697.6 billion, up 0.6 percent (± 0.5 percent) from the previous month, and up 2.5 percent (± 0.7 percent) above August 2022. Total sales for the June 2023 through August 2023 period were up 2.2 percent (± 0.4 percent) from the same period a year ago. The June 2023 to July 2023 percent change was revised from up 0.7 percent (± 0.5 percent) to up 0.5 percent (± 0.2 percent).

Retail trade sales were up 0.6 percent (± 0.5 percent) from July 2023, and up 1.6 percent (± 0.5 percent) above last year. Gasoline stations were down 10.3 percent (± 1.1 percent) from last year, while food services and drinking places were up 8.5 percent (± 2.3 percent) from August 2022.

General Information

The September 2023 Advance Monthly Retail report is scheduled for release on October 17, 2023 at 8:30 a.m. EDT. View the full schedule in the Economic Briefing Room: <https://www.census.gov/economic-indicators/>. The full text and tables of this release can be found at <https://www.census.gov/retail/>.

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EXPLANATORY NOTES

The advance estimates are based on a subsample of the Census Bureau's full retail and food services sample. A stratified random sampling method is used to select approximately 4,800 retail and food services firms whose sales are then weighted and benchmarked to represent the complete universe of over three million retail and food services firms. For more information on how data is collected for the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, see our methodology page at:

https://www.census.gov/retail/marts/how_surveys_are_collected.html.

Survey Description

The U.S. Census Bureau conducts the Advance Monthly Retail Trade and Food Services Survey to provide an early estimate of monthly sales by kind of business for retail and food service firms located in the United States. Each month, questionnaires are mailed to a probability sample of approximately 4,800 employer firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey. Advance sales estimates are computed using a link relative estimator. For each detailed industry, we compute a ratio of current-to-previous month weighted sales using data from units for which we have obtained usable responses for both the current and previous month. For each detailed industry, the advance total sales estimates for the current month is computed by multiplying this ratio by the preliminary sales estimate for the previous month (derived from the larger MRTS) at the appropriate industry level. Total estimates for broader industries are computed as the sum of the detailed industry estimates. The link relative estimate is used because imputation is not performed for most nonrespondents in MARTS. For a limited number of nonresponding companies that have influential effects on the estimates, sales may be estimated based on historical performance of that company. The monthly estimates are benchmarked to the annual survey estimates from the Annual Retail Trade Survey once available. The estimates are adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading day differences. Additional information on MARTS and MRTS can be found on the Census Bureau website at: www.census.gov/retail.

The Census Bureau has reviewed this data product to ensure appropriate access, use, and disclosure avoidance protection of the confidential source data (Project No. 7504206, Disclosure Review Board (DRB) approval number: CBDRB-FY23-001).

Reliability of Estimates

Because the estimates presented in this report are based on a sample survey, they contain sampling error and nonsampling error.

Sampling error is the difference between the estimate and the result that would be obtained from a complete enumeration of the sampling frame conducted under the same survey conditions. This error

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occurs because only a subset of the entire sampling frame is measured in a sample survey. Standard errors and coefficients of variation (CV), as given in Table 3 of this report, are estimated measures of sampling variation.

The margin of sampling error, as used on page 1, gives a range about the estimate which is a 90 percent confidence interval. If, for example, the percent change estimate is +1.2 percent and its estimated standard error is 0.9 percent, then the margin of sampling error is $\pm 1.753 \times 0.9$ percent or ± 1.6 percent, and the 90 percent confidence interval is -0.4 percent to +2.8 percent. If the interval contains 0, then one does not have sufficient evidence to conclude at the 90 percent confidence level that the change is different from zero and therefore the change is not statistically significant. Estimated changes shown in the text are statistically significant unless otherwise noted. For a monthly total, the median estimated coefficient of variation is given. The resulting confidence interval is the estimated value $\pm 1.753 \times CV \times$ (the estimated monthly total). The Census Bureau recommends that individuals using estimates in this report incorporate this information into their analyses, as sampling error could affect the conclusions drawn from the estimates.

Nonsampling error encompasses all other factors that contribute to the total error of a sample survey estimate. This type of error can occur because of nonresponse, insufficient coverage of the universe of retail businesses, mistakes in the recording and coding of data, and other errors of collection, response, coverage, or processing. Although nonsampling error is not measured directly, the Census Bureau employs quality control procedures throughout the process to minimize this type of error.

Weather Information

For information on the impact of weather events on the compilation of this report, please see the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) on our website at:

<www.census.gov/retail/marts_weather_faqs.html>

RESOURCES

The Rest of the Consumer Spending Story

Retail and services together represent what's commonly referred to as consumer spending. Quarterly Services Survey (QSS) revenue comprises roughly 2/3 of the personal consumption expenditures component of the U.S. Gross Domestic Product (GDP) measured by the Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA). The second quarter 2023 Quarterly Services Report was released on September 7, 2023 at 10:00 AM. Learn about historical revenue trends for certain industries going back 15 years and other data, such as in-patient days and discharges for hospitals, by visiting <<https://www.census.gov/services/index.html>>

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API

The Census Bureau's application programming interface lets developers create custom apps to reach new users and makes key demographic, socio-economic and housing statistics more accessible than ever before. <www.census.gov/developers/>

FRED Mobile App



Receive the latest updates on the nation's key economic indicators by downloading the FRED App <<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/fred-mobile/>> for both Apple and Android devices. FRED, the signature database of the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, now incorporates the Census Bureau's 13 economic indicators.

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Table 1. Estimated Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Total sales estimates are shown in millions of dollars and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS ¹ code	Kind of Business	Not Adjusted							Adjusted ²				
		8 Month Total		2023			2022		2023			2022	
		2023	% Chg. 2022	Aug. ³ (a)	Jul. (p)	Jun. (r)	Aug.	Jul.	Aug. ³ (a)	Jul. (p)	Jun. (r)	Aug. (r)	Jul. (r)
	Retail & food services,												
	total	5,461,511	3.0	719,201	699,095	705,527	698,833	685,483	697,557	693,668	690,518	680,721	675,822
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts) ...	4,387,906	2.9	577,181	563,440	565,183	562,924	557,906	564,027	560,495	556,836	552,766	551,528
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	5,025,608	4.8	659,408	642,149	649,196	632,519	613,183	642,295	641,135	638,019	619,091	609,431
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	3,952,003	5.1	517,388	506,494	508,852	496,610	485,606	508,765	507,962	504,337	491,136	485,137
	Retail	4,743,866	1.8	626,075	605,218	612,243	613,508	599,929	606,791	603,141	600,736	597,069	594,264
	GAFO⁴	(*)	(*)	(*)	127,051	127,006	131,100	126,879	(*)	129,002	128,324	128,748	127,579
441	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1,073,605	3.5	142,020	135,655	140,344	135,909	127,577	133,530	133,173	133,682	127,955	124,294
4411, 4412	Auto & other motor veh. dealers .	984,871	3.1	130,015	124,287	128,517	124,747	117,126	122,310	121,850	122,397	117,464	113,936
44111	New car dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	100,390	102,854	99,421	92,334	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4413	Auto parts, acc. & tire stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	11,368	11,827	11,162	10,451	(*)	11,323	11,285	10,491	10,358
442	Furniture & home furn. stores	88,957	-4.3	11,391	10,777	11,292	12,324	11,628	10,932	11,042	11,258	11,861	11,757
4421	Furniture stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	6,270	6,449	6,855	6,742	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4422	Home furnishings stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
443	Electronics & appliance stores	57,527	-2.2	7,662	7,164	7,327	7,787	7,472	7,732	7,678	7,762	7,874	7,966
444	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	339,207	-2.5	43,852	42,185	46,719	45,581	43,860	41,502	41,467	41,391	43,655	43,047
4441	Building mat. & sup. dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	36,724	39,872	40,043	38,435	(*)	35,620	35,473	37,529	37,099
445	Food & beverage stores.....	648,377	3.3	83,460	83,698	81,796	81,194	82,655	82,326	82,033	81,463	80,624	80,179
4451	Grocery stores	584,570	3.4	75,042	75,117	73,264	73,025	74,277	73,933	73,644	73,118	72,445	72,114
4453	Beer, wine & liquor stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	6,206	6,157	5,864	6,118	(*)	6,002	5,972	5,858	5,810
446	Health & personal care stores	281,687	8.0	36,639	34,762	36,200	33,997	32,344	36,240	36,060	36,020	33,627	33,587
44611	Pharmacies & drug stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	29,059	30,036	28,244	27,170	(*)	29,896	29,946	27,854	28,010
447	Gasoline stations	435,903	-13.6	59,793	56,946	56,331	66,314	72,300	55,262	52,533	52,499	61,630	66,391
448	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	193,681	1.4	26,991	25,319	24,809	26,049	24,904	26,201	25,971	25,736	25,862	25,318
44811	Men's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)
44812	Women's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	3,235	3,138	3,396	3,305	(*)	3,332	3,265	3,545	3,369
44814	Family clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	10,992	10,434	10,493	10,442	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4482	Shoe stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	3,356	3,063	4,095	3,291	(*)	3,268	3,255	3,310	3,149
451	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	65,118	1.0	9,294	8,534	8,653	9,449	8,524	8,550	8,690	8,542	8,669	8,567
452	General merchandise stores.....	562,025	3.1	74,547	72,603	72,387	72,390	71,573	73,228	73,007	72,448	71,760	71,294
4521	Department stores	83,366	-1.5	11,473	10,617	10,400	11,752	10,980	11,053	11,025	10,898	11,440	11,355
4529	Other general merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	61,986	61,987	60,638	60,593	(*)	61,982	61,550	60,320	59,939
45291	Warehouse clubs & supercenters.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	53,560	53,113	52,668	52,520	(*)	53,241	52,901	51,992	51,693
45299	All oth. gen. merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	8,426	8,874	7,970	8,073	(*)	8,741	8,649	8,328	8,246
453	Miscellaneous store retailers	121,530	2.7	15,738	15,535	16,656	15,963	15,459	15,181	15,375	15,536	15,246	15,157
454	Nonstore retailers	876,249	8.0	114,688	112,040	109,729	106,551	101,633	116,107	116,112	114,399	108,306	106,707
4541	Elect. shopping & m/o houses	(*)	(*)	(*)	103,437	100,106	96,899	92,990	(*)	106,089	104,169	97,680	96,363
722	Food services & drinking places	717,645	12.0	93,126	93,877	93,284	85,325	85,554	90,766	90,527	89,782	83,652	81,558

(*) Advance estimates are not available for this kind of business.

(NA) Not available (a) Advance estimate (p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(S) Estimate does not meet publication standards because of high sampling variability (coefficient of variation is greater than 30%), poor response quality (total quantity response rate is less than 50%), or other concerns about the estimate's quality.

(1) For a full description of the NAICS codes used in this table, see <<https://www.census.gov/naics/>>.

(2) Estimates are concurrently adjusted for seasonal variation and for holiday and trading day differences, but not for price changes. Concurrent seasonal adjustment uses all available unadjusted estimates as input to the X-13ARIMA-SEATS program. The factors derived from the program are used in calculating all seasonally adjusted estimates shown in this table. Year-to-date seasonally adjusted sales estimates are not tabulated. Adjustment factors and explanatory material can be found on the Internet at <<http://www.census.gov/retail/>>.

(3) Advance estimates are based on early reports obtained from a small sample of firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey (MRTS) sample. All other estimates are from the MRTS sample.

(4) GAFO represents firms which specialize in department store types of merchandise and is comprised of furniture & home furnishings (442), electronics & appliances (443), clothing & accessories (448), sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, and book (451), general merchandise (452), office supply, stationery, and gift stores (4532).

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, September 14, 2023. Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 2. Estimated Change in Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS code	Kind of Business	Percent Change ¹					
		Aug. 2023 Advance from --		Jul. 2023 Preliminary from --		Jun. 2023 through Aug. 2023 from --	
		Jul. 2023 (p)	Aug. 2022 (r)	Jun. 2023 (r)	Jul. 2022 (r)	Mar. 2023 through May 2023	Jun. 2022 through Aug. 2022
	Retail & food services,						
	total	0.6	2.5	0.5	2.6	1.3	2.2
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	0.6	2.0	0.7	1.6	1.2	1.4
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	0.2	3.7	0.5	5.2	1.5	4.4
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	0.2	3.6	0.7	4.7	1.4	4.0
	Retail	0.6	1.6	0.4	1.5	1.1	1.2
441	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	0.3	4.4	-0.4	7.1	1.8	5.8
4411, 4412	Auto & other motor veh. dealers ...	0.4	4.1	-0.4	6.9	1.6	5.6
442	Furniture & home furn. stores	-1.0	-7.8	-1.9	-6.1	-1.3	-6.1
443	Electronics & appliance stores	0.7	-1.8	-1.1	-3.6	0.5	-1.9
444	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	0.1	-4.9	0.2	-3.7	-0.3	-4.0
445	Food & beverage stores.....	0.4	2.1	0.7	2.3	0.1	1.9
4451	Grocery stores	0.4	2.1	0.7	2.1	0.0	1.7
446	Health & personal care stores	0.5	7.8	0.1	7.4	1.5	7.6
447	Gasoline stations	5.2	-10.3	0.1	-20.9	-1.2	-18.3
448	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	0.9	1.3	0.9	2.6	1.2	1.0
451	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	-1.6	-1.4	1.7	1.4	-0.1	-0.2
452	General merchandise stores.....	0.3	2.0	0.8	2.4	1.1	1.7
4521	Department stores	0.3	-3.4	1.2	-2.9	-1.7	-3.8
453	Miscellaneous store retailers	-1.3	-0.4	-1.0	1.4	-0.1	0.8
454	Nonstore retailers	0.0	7.2	1.5	8.8	3.0	8.1
722	Food services & drinking places	0.3	8.5	0.8	11.0	2.5	9.6

(p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(1) Estimates shown in this table are derived from adjusted estimates provided in Table 1 of this report.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, September 14, 2023. Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability.

Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at

<www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 3. Estimated Measures of Sampling Variability and Revision to Advance Estimates Aug. 2023

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey and Monthly Retail Trade Survey)

NAICS Code	Kind of Business	Median CV ⁽¹⁾ for Current Mo. (%)	Median standard error ⁽¹⁾ for Percent change			Revision for month-to-month change ⁽²⁾	
			Previous Mo. to Current Mo.	Previous Qtr. to Current Qtr.	Current Mo. to same Mo. Last Yr.	Average revision	Median absolute revision
441 4411, 4412 442 443 444 445 4451 446 447 448 451 452 4521 453 454 722	Retail & food services,						
	total	0.9	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.0	0.1
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	1.1	0.3	0.2	0.3	-0.1	0.1
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	0.9	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.0	0.2
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	1.2	0.3	0.2	0.4	-0.1	0.2
	Retail, total	0.7	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.1
	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1.6	1.0	0.4	1.1	0.2	0.3
	Auto & other motor veh. dealers	1.8	1.1	0.4	1.2	0.2	0.3
	Furniture & home furn. stores.....	2.7	1.7	0.7	1.7	-0.3	0.8
	Electronics & appliance stores	2.2	1.0	0.5	1.0	0.3	0.6
	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	2.5	0.7	0.5	1.1	-0.2	0.3
	Food & beverage stores.....	0.7	0.2	0.2	0.5	-0.1	0.2
	Grocery stores	0.7	0.2	0.2	0.5	-0.1	0.3
	Health & personal care stores	3.2	0.5	0.3	0.7	0.0	0.3
	Gasoline stations	1.3	0.4	0.4	0.6	-0.4	0.7
	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	2.9	0.9	0.6	1.4	-0.1	0.4
	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	2.4	1.1	0.9	1.6	0.4	0.2
	General merchandise stores.....	1.2	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.1
	Department stores	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.2	0.1
	Miscellaneous store retailers	5.2	2.6	1.2	2.8	0.1	0.7
	Nonstore retailers	1.9	0.5	0.4	0.9	0.0	0.4
	Food services & drinking places	3.6	0.9	0.7	1.3	-0.1	0.6

(1) Estimated measures of sampling variability are based on estimates not adjusted for seasonal variation or holiday or trading day variation. Medians are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

(2) These columns provide measures of the difference between the advance-to-preliminary and preliminary-to-final estimates of month-to-month change for the same pair of months as measured by the Advance sample and MRTS sample. The average and median revisions are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, September 14, 2023. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.